

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting complex commercial disputes, international arbitration and case preparation at BCLP, Freedom Law Clinic and Citizens Advice. Experienced in reviewing and managing large volumes of documents, preparing hearing bundles, drafting procedural documents and legal research across high-value matters. Currently advising clients at Citizens Advice on a range of legal matters including housing, employment and debt. Strong written communication skills and a sustained interest in commercial litigation, civil fraud and international disputes.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules: international arbitration, dispute resolution procedures, evidence analysis, legal research and transnational governance
- Dissertation: cross-jurisdictional development of data protection and GDPR (mark: 55)
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy): 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended substantive sections of the memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted targeted legal research
- Became the sole junior supporting the team ahead of a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked all outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files; monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements and matter opening and closure
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; tracked costs and deadlines throughout

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex legal points
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech compliance
- Identified legal and compliance risks arising from the client's data processing and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with Adobe's legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; document review and management; electronic bundling; electronic court filing portals; iManage; case management and time-recording systems; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; concise report and correspondence writing

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, structured case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters